

Father,

May this letter reach you before Charles and I do, to help you prepare for our impending arrival. We have successfully reached the town of Blair. I do not know what this place is called now, if it is called anything at all. Perhaps the wicked fate that befell the children of this town should have erased it from the map entirely. Charles and I thought we would settle it anew, making our home where no one else would dare. We thought to rechristen this place as Daventry, Maryland.

Sadly, it is not to be.

We heard the tales of what took place here, and yet we did not heed them as you said we should. We were fools. Charles and I are in grave danger, and I believe the only way to avoid it is to abandon this place entirely. I hope this letter will convince you to prepare for our impending arrival.

We attempted to build our home at a lovely spot near a waterfall. We were so close that the pleasant rushing of the falls lulled us to sleep each night. We never could have known the steady rumbling of that water concealed something much more sinister: the growling of a great and terrible beast.

The strangeness of the place began to reveal itself to us slowly. We found trees stretching towards the sky that we swore we had felled the day before. We saw lights, quite unlike firelight, coming from deep within the wood in the middle of the night, though we knew we must be the only two souls for miles.

Soon after, a fearful change came over Charles, something I could not quite define, a change that made him seem quite unlike himself. He began to complain of strange sensations. Simple things at first: a chill in the



air despite my having lit a fire in what we then hoped would one day become our dining area. Then, of simple aches and pains of the kind a boy experiences as he grows, only for that pain to escalate to what he deemed "unbearable" heights, as if his limbs were elongating. Just as suddenly those pains would disappear.

Charles then began sleepwalking - a complaint from which, as you know, he has never suffered. The first night, I found him standing aimlessly in the corner of our soon-to-be-home's foundation. Simply standing there. On the second occasion, this time during the day, I discovered Charles staring into the rushing currents of the waterfall. He spoke only of the voice of a woman drawing him deeper and deeper into the forest.

The terrible events culminated in a nighttime vision of the most frightening of specters, a devil that looked as if it were made of the forest itself, as if the trees and leaves and moss had all conspired together, and created the body of some great and terrifying demon. Charles and I could see it wandering the woods, its enormous height that of the trees of the forest. And ever so slowly, its head turned, and in its fiery eyes burned those same lights as we'd seen before. I believe, though I cannot explain how I know this, that the beast wanted us to see it. It wanted us to know it was there, for us to back in its power. It was some great, evil cat, and we but canaries in a cage.

There is a presence in these woods, something unholy, and I fear that not only does it intend to claim us both, but that its horrid grip is already wrapped tightly about Charles. I fear that, despite our efforts to make a new home here, the only way to save Charles may be to abandon it. You were right to warn us against coming here, Father. You were right to call us not men, but foolish children, to tell us to heed the tales of this abandoned town. I wonder if that will bring you some measure of peace or if